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Subject: [External] Proposal for SCORE's Role in Supporting Small Businesses through Artificial Intelligence (AI)
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Submitted to: Trump Administration's Request for Information on AI Development

Submitted by: SCORE-NYC

I. Introduction

SCORE, a nonprofit organization dedicated to mentoring and supporting small businesses, recognizes the transformative potential of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in driving economic growth and business success. AI offers small businesses an unprecedented opportunity to enhance efficiency, reduce costs, and compete effectively in the marketplace. This proposal outlines how SCORE can leverage AI to support small businesses and recommends policies that the federal government can adopt to facilitate AI integration at the small business level.

II. The Role of AI in Small Business Growth

AI can provide small businesses with solutions in multiple areas, including:

- **Customer Relationship Management (CRM):** AI-powered chatbots and automation tools can streamline customer service and engagement.
- **Marketing and Sales Optimization:** AI-driven analytics help small businesses understand consumer behavior and tailor marketing strategies.
- **Financial Management:** Automated bookkeeping and AI-powered forecasting tools can enhance decision-making.
- **Operational Efficiency:** AI-enabled inventory management and supply chain optimization reduce costs and inefficiencies.

III. SCORE's AI Action Plan for Small Businesses

SCORE proposes a structured AI action plan to support small businesses through education, mentorship, and accessible AI solutions. The key components of this plan include:

1. AI Training and Awareness Programs

- Develop educational materials and workshops on AI applications for small businesses.
- Partner with AI experts to provide webinars, training sessions, and mentorship.

- Create an online AI knowledge hub with case studies, best practices, and tutorials.

2. AI Adoption Mentorship Initiative

- Pair small businesses with AI-savvy SCORE mentors who can guide them through AI adoption.
- Establish an AI Help Desk to provide personalized recommendations on AI tools and vendors.

3. AI-Enabled Business Diagnostics

- Implement AI-powered assessments to evaluate business needs and recommend AI solutions.
- Develop tools that help small businesses analyze their operations and identify AI opportunities.

4. Collaborations with AI Innovators and Government Agencies

- Partner with technology firms and universities to offer AI solutions tailored for small businesses.
- Work with federal agencies to secure AI funding and grants for small business adoption.
- Advocate for policies that encourage AI-driven small business growth and protect entrepreneurs from AI-related risks.

IV. Federal Policy Recommendations

To maximize AI's impact on small businesses, SCORE recommends the following government actions:

1. **Funding and Grants:** Establish AI adoption grants and low-interest loans for small businesses investing in AI.
2. **AI Literacy Programs:** Support national AI training initiatives to enhance digital skills among small business owners.
3. **Ethical AI Standards:** Ensure that AI applications used by small businesses adhere to ethical guidelines and prevent data exploitation.
4. **Public-Private Partnerships:** Foster collaboration between AI developers, government agencies, and small business organizations to create user-friendly AI solutions.

V. Conclusion

AI has the potential to revolutionize small business operations, making them more competitive and resilient. By implementing this AI Action Plan, SCORE aims to equip small businesses with the knowledge, tools, and support they need to successfully integrate AI into their

operations. We urge the federal government to support these initiatives through strategic investments and policy frameworks that ensure inclusive and responsible AI adoption. Perhaps most important is the fact that SCORE is a volunteer organization, so implementation will be at no additional cost to taxpayers.

SCORE is committed to working alongside policymakers, technology leaders, and small business owners to build an AI-driven future that benefits all American entrepreneurs.

Robert Serabin

Chair of SCORE-NYC AI Task Force

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